



comes with a 16-inch, WQXGA (2560 x 1600), 16:10, IPS Panel with a refresh of 240 Hz. The panel has an advertised peak brightness of 500 nits, we tested 511 nits during our testing. We also tested an sRGB gamut coverage of 99.5 per cent, and a DCI-P3 gamut coverage of 96.5 per cent. Not only are these excellent scores, they're better than last year's model. The presence of a microSD card reader also means that Acer has taken creators considering this laptop into account as well. With the display on this laptop, it's worth considering for creative workloads.

PERFORMANCE

The Acer Predator Helios Neo 16 comes with a 14th-generation Intel Core i9-14900HX which is paired with an NVIDIA GeForce RTX 4070 Laptop GPU with a TGP of 140 W. This is a great opportunity to compare the Helios Neo 16 2024 with the recently launched HP

OMEN 16 2024 which is slightly cheaper but features a 14th-generation Intel Core i7-14700HX and an NVIDIA GeForce RTX 4060 Laptop GPU. The HP OMEN 16 is priced at INR 1,60,990 while the Acer Predator Helios Neo 16 is priced at INR 1,79,999. Let's see how much of a difference in performance 20K can give you. We'll start with productivity and processor performance.

We use the PCMark 10 benchmark to test general productivity and the Cinebench R23 and Geekbench 6 benchmarks to test for single-core and multi-core performance.

You can see that for the most part, the Intel Core i9-14900HX in the Acer Predator Helios Neo 16 ends up outperforming the Intel Core i7-14700HX on the HP OMEN 16. As it should. The difference is especially noticeable in the Cinebench R23 multi-core performance score, however, single-core performance remains relatively similar.

GAMING PERFORMANCE

The RTX 4070 on the Helios Neo 16 2024 is a tier higher than the RTX 4060 on the HP OMEN 16. Both come with TGPs of 140 W, which is the highest allowed configuration by NVIDIA. We start things off with synthetic gaming benchmarks for which we use 3DMark.

Here, the RTX 4070 on the Helios Neo 16 2024 outperforms the RTX 4060 on the HP OMEN 16 across the board. Logically this makes complete sense, as the RTX 4070 is the better GPU on paper. However, this didn't necessarily reflect in all real-world gaming benchmarks.

In real-world gaming performance, the Predator Helios Neo 16 performs better in all our gaming benchmarks. Some titles, like Shadow of the Tomb Raider and Cyberpunk 2077 are very close in terms of scores, however. That said, the numbers are still great, and there is a significant lead in FPS numbers for other titles, like Red Dead Redemption, Civilization VI, and Metro Exodus. Taking the overall scores into consideration, the Acer Predator Helios Neo 16 is the best-performing gaming laptop we've tested in the sub-2 lakh category.

VERDICT

Verdict: The Acer Predator Helios Neo 16 2024 offers top-tier gaming performance with its Intel Core i9-14900HX processor and NVIDIA GeForce RTX 4070 GPU. Its premium design, excellent display, and impressive thermal management further enhance its appeal. Despite its slightly higher price tag, it outperforms its competitors in the sub-2 lakh category, making it a worthy investment for gaming enthusiasts seeking high performance without breaking the bank.

—Manish Rajesh

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Intel Core i9-14900HX (24C / 32T)
Max clock 5.8 GHz | GPU: NVIDIA GeForce RTX 4070 | VRAM: 8 GB | TGP: 140 W (115 W + 25 W Dynamic boost) | RAM: 16 GB DDR5-5600 | Storage: 1 TB NVMe SSD

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